

Tambu's relation to food mirrors her relation to education. Food is a means to escape. We see this literally in the beginning when she is able to pay for her schooling by selling food. When her brother stole her corn, he was stealing her education and such her ability to control her destiny. She differs from Nyasha in that African food is authentic to her. Compared to Babamakuru's family she was the only one who liked Sadza

*"I was very pleased to see the sadza when it came, although nobody else seemed to care for it. This was embarrassing. There were many things that were embarrassing about that meal: my place looked as though a small and angry child had been fed there; here I was with a spoon in my hand instead of a fork and now Maiguru was dishing sadza on to my plate, sadza that nobody else would eat"*

While Nyasha does not find any food authentic, Tambu does. However, she is embarrassed by this and so as Nyasha forces up food, Tambu forces down food. Contrasting Nyasha even more, Tambu takes food as means of control. She eats, even though she is as aware as anyone the weight it carries. Tambu's character is that which Fanon would call the "colonized intellectual"

*"During this period the intellectual behaves objectively like a vulgar opportunist. His maneuvering, in fact, is still at work. The people would never think of rejecting him or cutting the ground from under his feet. "*

As a child - through adolescence Tambu is constantly maneuvering. Her interactions with food represent this. She will eat whatever it takes whether it be potatoes and gravy, or sadza to escape her colonial bonds.

In part Tambu's ability to eat food and assimilate to the patriarchy is buoyed by her ability to create it. Tambu grew her own vegetables from the ground. She is free from the power that Babamukuru wields over Nyasha. But as we will see as we look at Lucia, we see how Tambu is still the colonized intellectual, as she maneuvers towards her own success instead of helping Nyasha.